AI AUTOMATION AGENCY

AUTOMATION ENGAGEMENT REPORT

FULL FINDINGS · DIAGNOSIS · RECOMMENDED SOLUTION

Hotel Booking **Communication Flow**

Santorini Breeze Hotel — April 2026

Nikos Papadopoulos
Client

Santorini, Greece
Location

45 Rooms
Property Size

Make.com + Cloudbeds
Recommended Stack

€5,900
ANNUAL COST FOUND

3–4×
MISSED EMAILS / WEEK

€16/mo
SOLUTION COST

Confidential · AI Automation Agency · 2026

Prepared for Santorini Breeze Hotel

01 — OVERVIEW

What We **Found** & What We **Recommend**

We ran a structured diagnostic interview with Nikos Papadopoulos, owner of Santorini Breeze Hotel. Our job was not to accept the stated problem at face value, but to find the real root cause — where time, money, and quality are actually being lost in the operation.

What we found: a fully manual guest communication workflow with zero automation at any step. Every confirmation email, pre-arrival message, and invoice is typed and sent by hand — across three staff members — during the hotel's most critical period.

ANNUAL COST OF THE PROBLEM

€5,900

per year in direct staff time alone

Before counting invoice disputes, guest experience failures, and emergency calls in peak season

3–4×

Missed pre-arrival emails per week in August — every one triggers an emergency call

63

Bookings per week at peak — all handled manually by 3 staff members

0

Prior automation attempts — this is a completely untouched process

Our Recommendation

A **trigger-based automation on Make.com** connected to Cloudbeds and Gmail that handles every routine guest touchpoint automatically — from the moment a booking is confirmed to the PDF invoice on

checkout day. Cost: **~€16/month**. Return: **~€5,900/year**.

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02 — THE DIAGNOSTIC INTERVIEW

What We **Asked.** What We **Discovered.**

We conducted a four-round structured interview. We never accepted the first answer. Our goal was to surface the real cost — not just the surface complaint.

> *"Booking comes in on Booking.com. Maria sees it in the morning when she checks. She copies the guest name into Excel, opens Gmail, types the confirmation from a Word template. Then 3 days before arrival she must remember the pre-arrival email. Then after checkout she makes the invoice in another Excel file. Sometimes she forgets the pre-arrival. Sometimes the invoice has wrong dates."*
>
> — Nikos Papadopoulos, Santorini Breeze Hotel · Round 1 of the diagnostic interview

What the Process Actually Looks Like Today

⚠ TODAY — MANUAL & ERROR-PRONE

- Maria checks Booking.com **manually every morning** — overnight bookings not seen until next day
- Copy-paste from Cloudbeds → Excel → Word template → Gmail
- Pre-arrival email relies entirely on **Maria's memory** — no scheduling exists
- Invoice built manually in a separate Excel file — wrong VAT and wrong

✓ AFTER AUTOMATION — INSTANT & ACCURATE

- Cloudbeds fires a **real-time signal** the moment any booking is confirmed on any channel
- Confirmation email sent to guest **within minutes** — personalised, branded, accurate
- Pre-arrival email **scheduled automatically** to D-3 at 09:00 — no one has to remember
- Correct PDF invoice generated on checkout day — right VAT, right

dates are recurring

📞 3–4 guests per week in August call the hotel lost — interrupting staff at peak hours

dates, every time

🤯 Maria's communication workload in peak season **reduced by ~80%**

The Pain Points — Quantified

3–4×

Missed pre-arrival emails per week (Aug)

Each one becomes an emergency call. Maria stops what she's doing — during check-in hours — to give directions by phone.

1 dispute

Corporate client invoice dispute (confirmed)

Wrong VAT, wrong dates — not an isolated incident. A formal dispute with a corporate client was the result.

15 min

Staff time per booking, all manual

Confirmation + pre-arrival scheduling + invoice across 3 people in peak season. Multiplied by 63 bookings/week.

30%

Direct bookings with zero auto-acknowledgement

Website contact form submissions get no auto-reply. Potential guests wait with no confirmation their inquiry was received.

03 — THE NUMBERS

The **Real Cost** of Doing Nothing

We asked Nikos for staff hourly rates and booking volumes. From those numbers, we calculated the true annual cost of the current manual process.

Annual Staff Time Cost — Breakdown

Peak season comms Jun–Sep · 3 staff · 17 wks	€3,264	€3,264
Off-peak comms Oct–May · Maria only · 35 wks	€2,205	€2,205
Error rework Calls + invoice corrections		€400+
Total Annual Cost		**~€5,900 / year**

Cost Breakdown & Distribution

€3,264
Peak season (Jun–Sep) — 55% of total

€2,205
Off-peak (Oct–May) — 38% of total

€400+
Error rework & disputes — 7% of total

Assumptions: 15 min/booking avg · €12/hr blended peak · €14/hr Maria off-peak · 3 calls/week peak × 20 min · does not include client relationship cost or lost future

bookings.

Return on Investment

SOLUTION COST (ANNUAL)

€192

Make.com Core plan · €16/month

30×

ANNUAL SAVINGS

€5,900

Recovered in staff time alone

04 — OPERATIONAL CONTEXT

Your **Operation.** Fully **Mapped.**

Before designing anything, we mapped every trigger, data source, tool, and person involved in this process. No assumptions. No guessing.

Your Current Technology Stack

TOOL	CURRENT PURPOSE	VOLUME / NOTES	AFTER AUTOMATION
Cloudbeds	PMS + channel manager — connects Booking.com, Airbnb, website widget	Source of all reservation data	KEEP · NEW WEBHOOK
Gmail	All outbound guest communication	All 3 email types sent from here	KEEP · AUTO-CONNECTED
WordPress + CF7	Direct booking inquiry form	~30% of all bookings originate here	KEEP · WEBHOOK ADDED
Excel (invoicing)	Manual invoice creation — error-prone	Wrong VAT & dates are recurring issues	REPLACE
Make.com	— (not in use today)	New · connects all tools above	NEW · RECOMMENDED

Booking Volumes

PERIOD	DAILY AVG	WEEKLY AVG	DURATION	STAFF INVOLVED
Peak season (Jun–Sep)	~9 / day	~63 / week	17 weeks	Maria + 2 staff
Off-peak (Oct–May)	~2.5 / day	~18 / week	35 weeks	Maria only
Direct (Contact Form 7)	~30% of total across all periods — currently unautomated, no auto-reply to potential guests			

People Involved

Maria

Senior receptionist · €14/hr · Owns the entire comms process · Primary alert recipient post-launch

2 Staff

Peak season only · €11/hr each · Assist Maria with manual sends · Role in comms eliminated post-automation

Nikos

Owner · Escalation point · System access approvals · Receives error alerts alongside Maria

05 — WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

The Automation, **Step by Step**

Every guest communication from booking to checkout, handled automatically. Your team does nothing for any of these to happen.

Trigger — New Booking in Cloudbeds

A webhook fires the moment a reservation is confirmed on any channel — Booking.com, Airbnb, or your website widget. Make.com receives the full reservation data and validates it immediately. If anything is missing (e.g. no guest email), Maria is alerted instantly with the booking ID.

Real-time trigger | Cloudbeds webhook

1 Confirmation Email Sent

Within minutes of the booking, the guest receives a personalised confirmation from your hotel's Gmail — their name, room type, check-in/out dates, rate, breakfast inclusion, cancellation policy, and your direct contact details. Branded. Accurate. Zero typing by Maria.

Sent instantly | Via Gmail | Personalised template

2 Pre-Arrival Email — Scheduled Automatically

The automation calculates exactly 3 days before check-in and schedules the pre-arrival email to fire at 09:00 Europe/Athens. For last-minute bookings (check-in within 3 days), it sends immediately. No one on your team has to remember, set a reminder, or calendar anything.

Scheduled · D-3 at 09:00 | Instant for late bookings

3 Pre-Arrival Email Delivered

The guest receives: directions from Santorini port and airport, parking information, check-in time (15:00), WiFi name and password, breakfast time and location, and an emergency contact number. Everything they need, before they need it. Zero missed sends.

Automatic | Zero missed sends

4

PDF Invoice Generated & Emailed on Checkout

On checkout day at 11:00, the automation pulls the final reservation data from Cloudbeds, generates a correctly calculated PDF invoice — hotel logo, 13% VAT, correct dates, correct totals — and emails it to the guest. For corporate clients, the invoice is produced in both English and Greek.

Checkout day · 11:00 | PDF attachment | EN + GR for corporate

+

Website Inquiries — Instant Acknowledgement

When a potential guest submits your WordPress contact form, they receive an automatic reply within seconds confirming their inquiry was received. Maria gets a formatted summary in her inbox — ready to reply. Every inquiry is logged to a Google Sheet automatically.

Instant auto-reply | Maria notified | Logged to Google Sheets

Error Handling — Nothing Falls Through the Cracks

⚠ **Email fails to send**

System retries automatically → If retry fails: Maria + Nikos receive an alert with the guest's details and clear manual instructions

⚠ **Guest email missing from booking**

Immediate alert to Maria with booking ID → Maria fixes the booking manually → Flow can be re-triggered

⚠ **PDF invoice generation fails**

Retry once → If still fails: plain-text invoice sent as fallback → Alert Maria to send PDF version manually

⚠ **Duplicate booking detected (same booking ID)**

Automation skips it automatically — no double emails sent to guests under any circumstances

06 — WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

Your Operation **After This Is Built**

At the end of the first peak season after launch, this is what your operation looks like:

- ✓ Maria sends **zero** manual confirmation or pre-arrival emails
- ✓ Zero guests arrive in August without pre-arrival information
- ✓ Every invoice is **correct on the first send** — right VAT, right dates
- ✓ No more emergency calls from lost guests during check-in hours
- ✓ Website inquiries acknowledged **within seconds**, every single time
- ✓ Maria's comms workload reduced by **~80%** in peak season

What This Automation Does NOT Do

OUT OF SCOPE	REASON	PATH FORWARD
Greek tax authority (myDATA) integration	Separate regulatory system requiring dedicated build	Recommended Phase 2
Airbnb in-app messaging	Airbnb's platform restricts external automation of their messaging	Platform limitation
Cancellation & rebooking flows	Separate trigger and logic from confirmed bookings	Recommended Phase 3

OUT OF SCOPE	REASON	PATH FORWARD
Human judgment for disputes	Maria and Nikos remain in the loop for all exceptions	By design

What We Need From Nikos to Get Started

1. **Cloudbeds API key** — Settings → API in Cloudbeds. We'll guide you through it. Takes 5 minutes.
2. **Gmail account access** — Connected via Google OAuth in Make.com. No password is ever shared.
3. **Hotel logo file** — PNG or SVG, transparent background. Goes on the invoice template.
4. **Invoice legal details** — Hotel legal name, ΑΦΜ (VAT number), registered address for the invoice header.
5. **Email template approval** — We draft both templates and show you before anything goes live. One round of feedback.
6. **Make.com account** — Free to create at make.com. Free trial for the first 30 days. We'll walk you through it.

07 — THE ROAD AHEAD

Three **Follow-On Opportunities**

Based on everything we learned, these are the highest-value automation opportunities to pursue once the booking communication flow is live and stable.

NEXT · 1–2 MONTHS AFTER LAUNCH

COMPLEXITY

1. Guest Review Request Flow

Low

After checkout, most hotels lose the review opportunity because the request arrives too late, too early, or never at all. An automated review request fires 24 hours after checkout — personalised from Nikos, linking directly to Booking.com and Google review pages. A gentle follow-up fires 3 days later for guests who didn't open the first email.

Why now: Uses the exact same checkout-day trigger already deployed. Zero new infrastructure. Industry data shows this increases review volume by 30–50% — directly lifting Booking.com ranking.

BUILD TIME	NEW TOOLS	IMPACT
1–2 weeks	**None**	**+30–50% reviews**

BEFORE NEXT SUMMER

COMPLEXITY

2. Cancellation & Rebooking Flow

Medium

When a guest cancels, the room sits empty unless someone acts fast. A cancellation in Cloudbeds triggers two flows simultaneously: a recovery email to the cancelled guest offering flexible rebooking, and an internal alert to Nikos with the room, dates, and availability to decide whether to push a last-minute deal.

Why now: A single recovered room night in July or August is worth €200–400. Even a 10% recovery rate pays for this build many times over in the first summer.

BUILD TIME	POTENTIAL VALUE	IMPACT
3–4 weeks	**€200–400 / recovered night**	**High in peak season**

BEFORE SECOND SEASON

3. Seasonal Upsell & Loyalty Flow

COMPLEXITY

High

Returning guests are the most valuable and least expensive to acquire — but most hotels treat them identically to first-timers. This flow recognises returning guests automatically, sends pre-season priority booking windows to past guests, and offers room upgrades to incoming guests 2 weeks before arrival.

Why now: The guest data already exists in Cloudbeds. Early-season outreach can fill 10–20% of peak inventory before it hits booking platforms — at zero channel commission (typically 15–18% on Booking.com).

BUILD TIME	COMMISSION SAVED	NEW DATA
6–8 weeks	**15–18% per direct booking**	**Guest history from Cloudbeds**

08 — THE PLAN

Automation **Roadmap**

NOW

Booking Communication Flow — Build & Launch

Confirmation + pre-arrival + PDF invoice + inquiry handling. €16/month. Returns €5,900/year. Ready to build on approval.

+1–2 MO

Guest Review Request Flow

Low complexity. Uses existing infrastructure. 1–2 weeks to build. Directly impacts Booking.com ranking.

PRE-SUMMER

Cancellation & Rebooking Flow

Medium complexity. 3–4 weeks to build. Highest impact in peak season when recovered rooms are most valuable.

SEASON 2

Seasonal Upsell & Loyalty Flow

High complexity. 6–8 weeks to build. Turns a transactional hotel into a relationship-driven one with zero additional acquisition cost.

What Happens After You Approve

STEP	ACTION	WHO
1	Credential collection — Cloudbeds API key, Gmail OAuth, Make.com account setup	Nikos + Consultant · ~30 min
2	Email template drafts reviewed and approved by Nikos and Maria	One round of feedback

STEP	ACTION	WHO
3	Full automation built and tested — happy path, late bookings, corporate invoices, all error paths	Consultant · 1–2 weeks
4	Handover — Maria and Nikos walked through the system; scenario turned on	Consultant + Nikos + Maria
5	30-day check-in — volume review, error audit, team feedback, seasonal tuning	One month after go-live

THE QUESTION FOR NIKOS

Does this report capture the real problem you're facing?

Once you approve, we build.